

egotism of both generals was the main cause, but Davis could have managed the problems better.

Davis's failings in personnel management had the most serious consequences in the important Western theater. He relied too much on the capabilities of General Albert Sidney Johnston at the start of the war. More seriously, he allowed the high command of the Army of Tennessee to become a dysfunctional nest of intrigue, as various corps commanders worked to undermine General Braxton Bragg.

Bragg had certain virtues, including organizational acumen, but mixed abilities on the battlefield—revealed in the Chaplin Hills (Perryville) campaign of 1862—and his troops and subordinates heartily disliked him. In October 1863 matters came to a head, and Davis traveled west in an attempt to resolve the issue. Unfortunately, Davis left Bragg in command, instead of replacing him with a general who had the confidence of the army and punishing those officers who had been most insubordinate. The crisis would fester until Bragg was removed.